

TEACHING TIPS:

- As much of this song is in a low register, ensure the children aren't tempted to 'belt' it out or shout, and use lots of support when moving into head voice for the higher notes at the end of the verses ('power and resurrection').
- The rhythm of the words in the first and fifth lines of each verse will need careful practice. Speak them a couple of times first, in rhythm, before singing them.
- Listen to the use of **dynamics** at the end of the song, during the 'We're coming alive' section. Encourage your singers to make the most of this gradual and spine-tingling **crescendo**.

WHAT YOU NEED

Pitched percussion and/or keyboards

LISTEN

At the end of this song, there is a repeated lyric, 'We're coming alive!'. Listen to **After The Rain (1983) by Frank Denyer**. The composer was inspired to write this from "experiencing the astonishing transformation of an area of semi-desert, when, after a sustained period of drought, a modest shower totally transformed the barren landscape in a very short time into one exploding with life." Denyer's use of sound and instrumentation could inspire similar class compositions on this theme.

DID YOU KNOW?

Bells are among the **oldest and simplest** musical instruments in the world, used throughout many of the world's religions – from Anglican church bells to Shintoist and Buddhist bells. In Roman Catholicism, bells symbolize the voice of God, and are used to call people to worship, as well as for ceremonies such as weddings and funerals. In Russian Orthodoxy, enormous bells are used to directly address God.

TEMPO

The speed of the music

PITCH

How high or low a note sits
Scale – an arrangement of notes in ascending or descending order of pitch

DYNAMICS

Crescendo – a gradual increase in volume

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 7 - 11



Listen carefully to the backing track, particularly the introduction. Can the class hear the bell-like sounds? Now listen to the melody. Can they hear any phrases that might sound like bells? The **descending scale** in bar 8 'Shout it from the rooftops' sounds a bit like a **peal of church bells**. Remind the class that a scale is a set of notes that go up and down. Can the children play this 'micro' scale of D major (as it is only 6 notes rather than 8) on keyboards, chime bars or glockenspiels?



(If you don't have sets of the above notes use the scale of C but starting at A: A G F E D C. You will get the same effect.)

Can they play the scale together as a class, with each note sounding at the same time? You will need to count them in and keep to a steady pulse. Now, split the class into two groups and have the second group start their scale slightly after the first group, like a round. Decide how many times you are going to repeat the scale. Split into further groups, with each group starting their scale in turn, but overlapping with the other groups. The effect should be something similar to pealing bells. **Experiment with the tempo** i.e. have some groups performing their scale faster and others slower.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To play the notes of a 'micro' scale.

To perform a scale as a round, in groups.